8. Configuring User Management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

1. Aim

To configure user management, custom roles and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in the Student Admission Enquiry Management application developed using Zoho Creator, restricting access to admission enquiries, follow-up information and counselling records according to staff responsibilities.

2. Objective

• Understand user permissions, roles and data sharing in Zoho Creator.

• Create distinct roles for Admin, Admission Staff and Counsellor.

• Configure component-level access for admission forms, reports and dashboards.

• Set up a read-only sharing rule so Counsellors can view admission enquiry records shared by Admission Staff.

• Review user assignment and distinguish configured access from verified multi-user access.

3. Tools Required

• Zoho Creator account with application administrator access.

• Student Admission Enquiry Management application.

• Admission Enquiry Form, Follow-up Activity History, admission reports and management dashboards.

4. Procedure

Step 1: Defining Roles in Zoho Creator

1. Open the application in Zoho Creator builder mode and go to **Settings > User Permissions > Roles**.

2. Create an **Admin** role reporting to CEO. Create **Admission Staff** and **Counsellor** roles reporting to Admin.

3. Define responsibilities: Admin supervises access and admissions operations; Admission Staff handles enquiries and follow-ups; Counsellor handles counselling-related information.

Step 2: Configuring Component-Level Permissions

1. Navigate to **Settings > User Permissions > Permissions**.

2. Create the **Admission Staff** permission set with access to admission enquiry and follow-up forms, selected report viewing/editing permissions, and relevant dashboards. Delete access is not enabled in the captured setup.

3. Create the **Counsellor** permission set with selected enquiry-report viewing access and counselling-related dashboard access. Editing is restricted to selected records/reports; delete permissions are not enabled in the captured setup.

4. Save the permission sets. Component permissions and organizational roles are configured separately in Zoho Creator.

Step 3: Configuring Record-Level Data Sharing

1. Open the **Data Sharing** tab and choose **Add Rule**.

2. Select **Admission Enquiry Form**, share records **from Admission Staff to Counsellor**, and set access to **Read Only**.

3. Save the rule as **Admission_Enquiry_To_Counsellor**. This is a role-based sharing rule, not a demonstrated per-user `zoho.loginuser` criteria filter.

Step 4: Inviting Users and Assigning Roles

1. Use the application **Share** option, enter a distinct user email address, and choose the required permission set.

2. A sharing attempt using the existing application administrator email was rejected because that account already had administrator access.

3. Consequently, a successful new-user invitation and end-to-end access check are **not verified** in the available screenshots.

5. Screenshot

Figure 1. Role hierarchy showing CEO, Admin, Admission Staff and Counsellor.

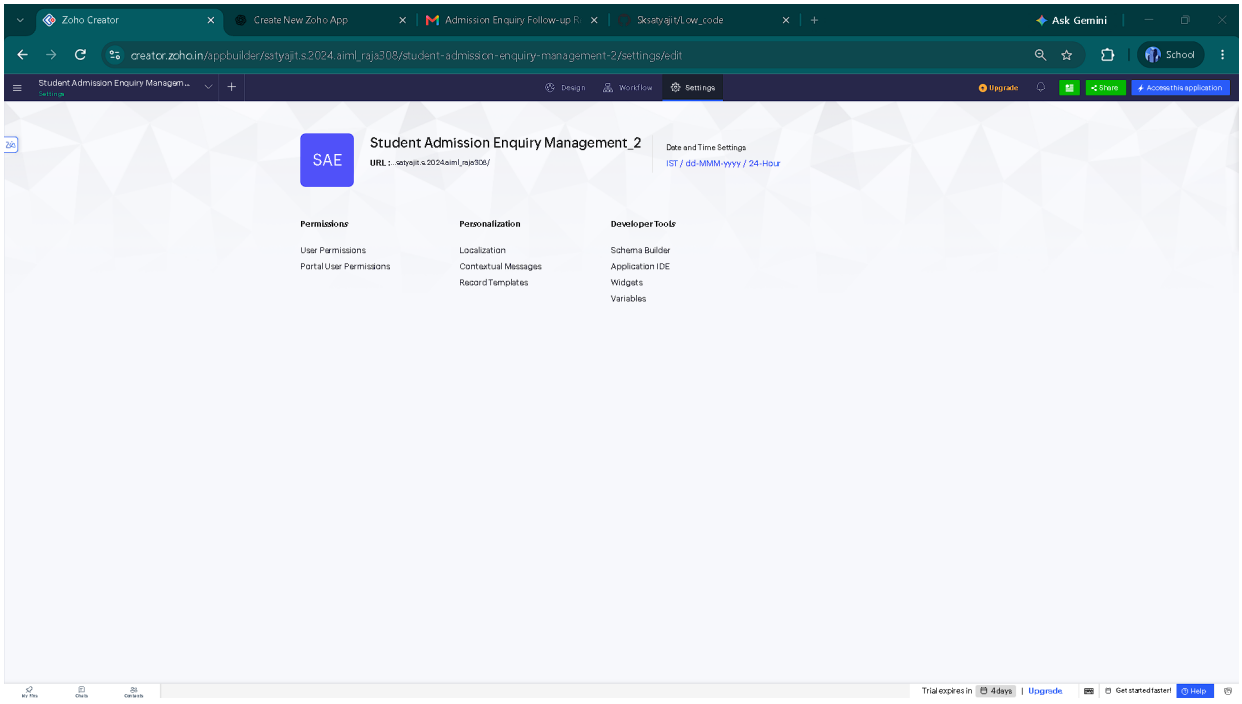
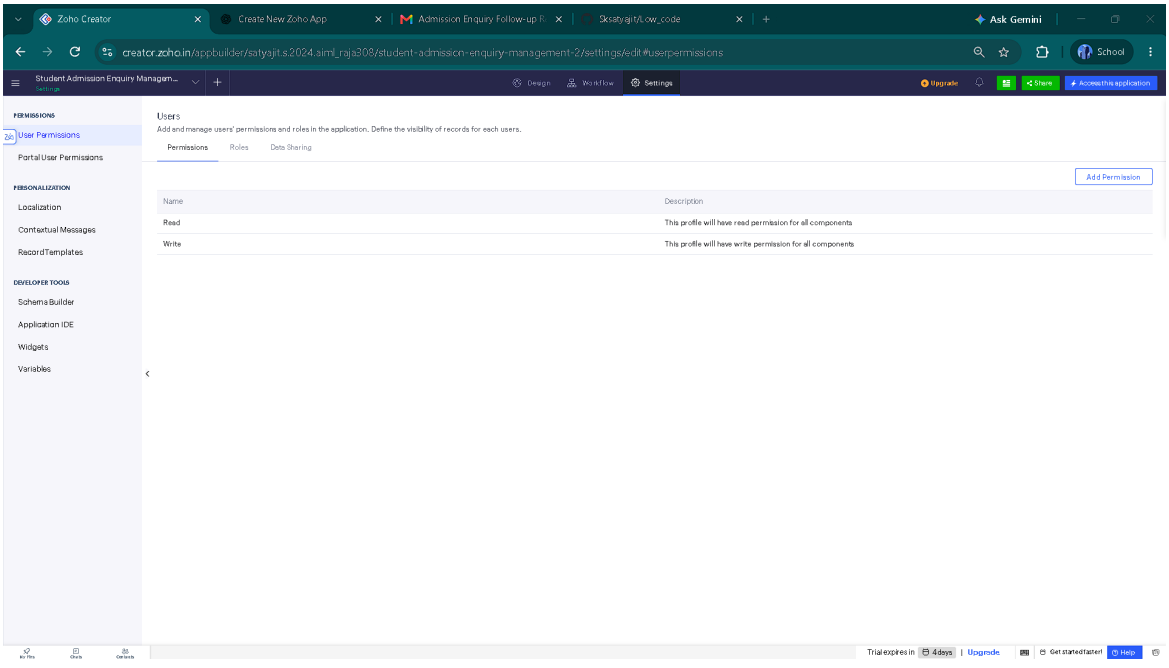


Figure 2. Counsellor role details, reporting to Admin.



5. Screenshot (Continued)

Figure 3. Permission configuration for Admission Staff.

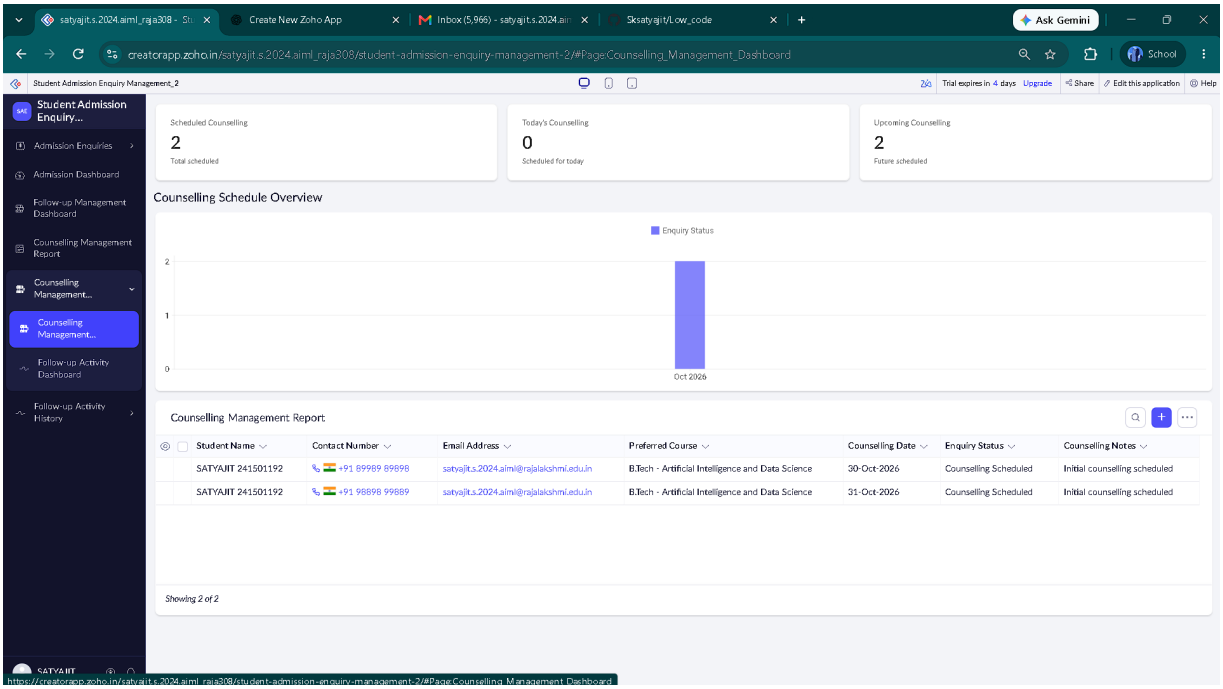
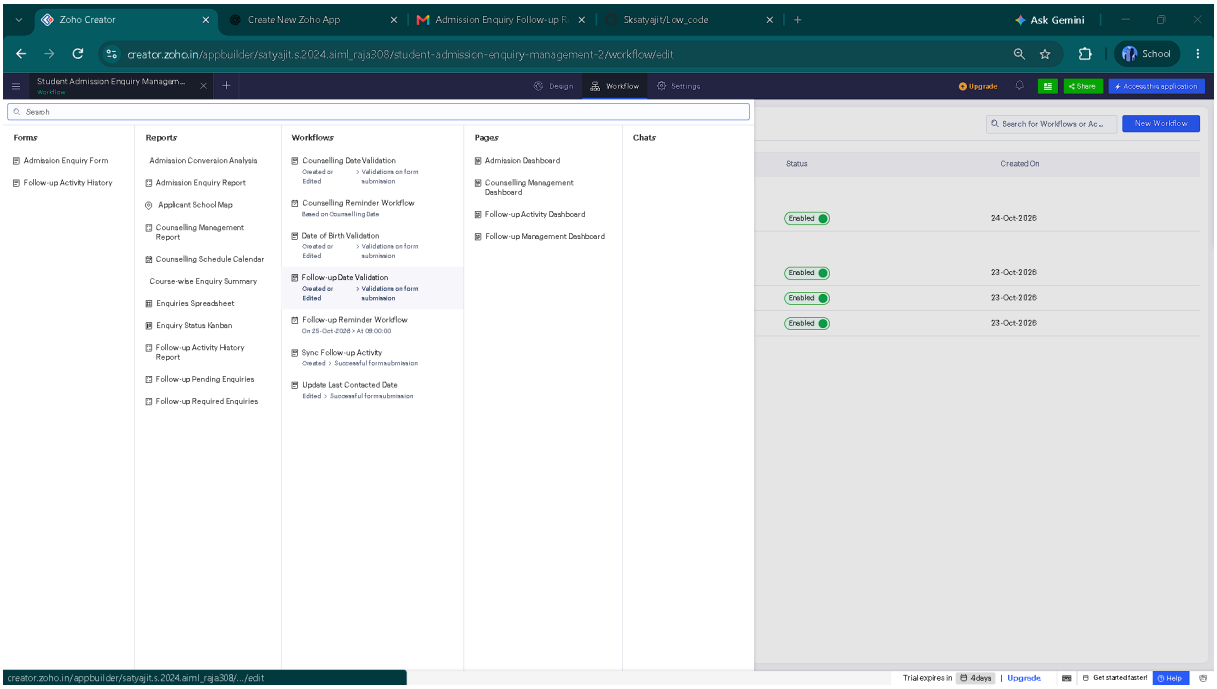


Figure 4. Counsellor permission configuration.



5. Screenshot (Continued)

Figure 5. Admission Enquiry to Counsellor data sharing rule (Read Only).

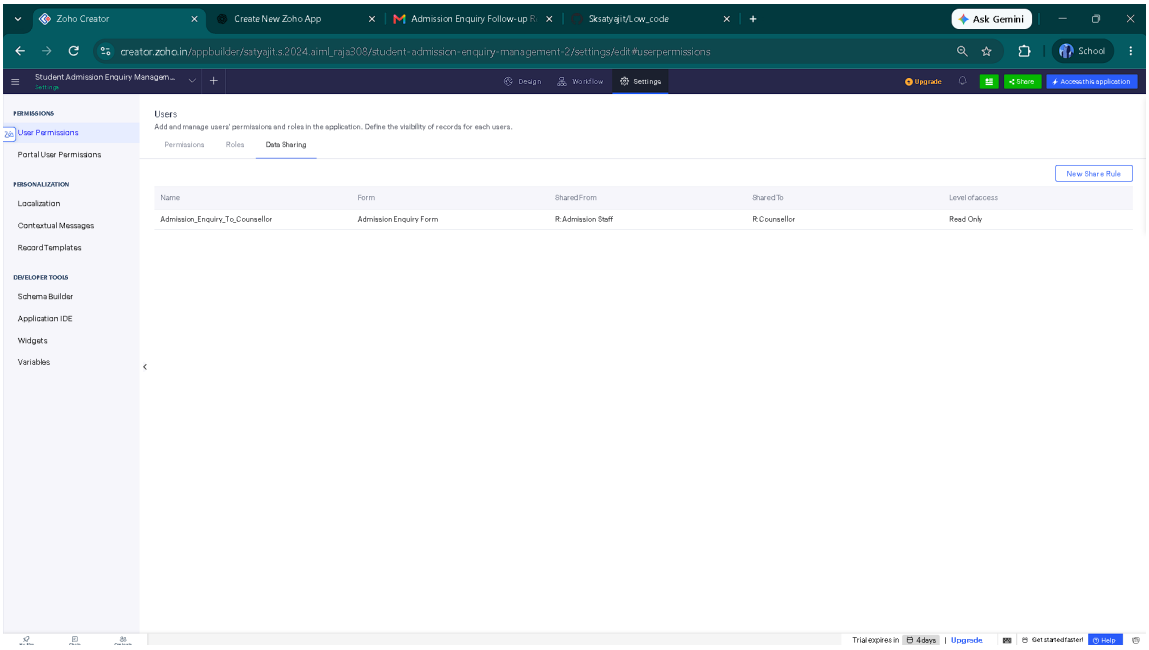
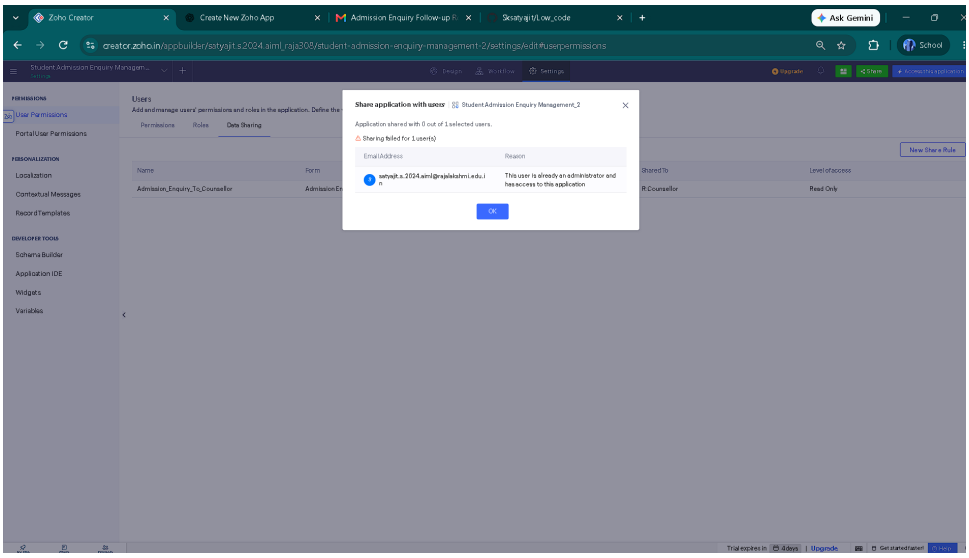


Figure 6. User-sharing attempt rejected for an existing administrator account.



6. Result

User roles, permission sets and a read-only data sharing rule were configured for the Student Admission Enquiry Management application in Zoho Creator. The available screenshots establish the configuration of the role hierarchy and access controls. Successful invitation of a separate user and enforcement of permissions under that account were not demonstrated; therefore, operational RBAC validation remains outside the documented scope.